

Summer Reading 2026

Incoming 9th Grade

Read with a purpose. Consider how the protagonist's journey — or the author's argument — illuminates broader societal questions, and what the challenges faced, moral dilemmas encountered, and transformative moments reveal.

FICTION

Divine Rivals

Rebecca Ross

Fantasy, Steampunk

The Reappearance of Rachel Price

Holly Jackson

Thriller, Suspense

Absalom's Daughters

Suzanne Feldman

Historical Fiction, Coming of Age

Another Brooklyn

Jacqueline Woodson

Historical Fiction, Coming of Age

The Book of Aron

Jim Shepard

Historical Fiction, Holocaust

Fallen Angels

Walter Dean Myers

Historical Fiction, War

Swagger

Carl Deuker

Sports Fiction, Coming of Age

Unbroken

Marieke Nijkamp (ed.)

Short Stories, Disability

We Are Not Free

Traci Chee

Historical Fiction, Japanese American

With the Fire on High

Elizabeth Acevedo

Coming of Age, Food Fiction

You Should See Me in a Crown

Leah Johnson

Realistic Fiction, LGBTQ, Romance

Carry On

Rainbow Rowell

Fantasy, Romance

Deepfake

Sarah Darer Littman

Realistic Fiction, Thriller

Dragon Hoops

Gene Luen Yang

Graphic Novel, Sports

Ruthless Vows

Rebecca Ross

Fantasy, Steampunk

Sunrise on the Reaping

Suzanne Collins

Dystopia, Science Fiction

After the Shot Drops

Randy Ribay

Realistic Fiction, Sports

Black Enough

Ibi Zoboi (ed.)

Short Stories, Coming of Age

Fahrenheit 451

Ray Bradbury

Classic, Dystopia

Firsts and Lasts

Laura Silverman (ed.)

Short Stories, Coming of Age

Today Tonight Tomorrow

Rachel Lynn Solomon

Realistic Fiction, Romance

The Way You Make Me Feel

Maurene Goo

Realistic Fiction, Romance

When I Was the Greatest

Jason Reynolds

Realistic Fiction, Urban

World War Z

Max Brooks

Horror, Satire, Epistolary

A Pho Love Story

Loan Le

Realistic Fiction, Romance

Copper Sun

Sharon M. Draper

Historical Fiction, Slavery

Don't Ask Me Where I'm From

Jennifer De Leon

Realistic Fiction, Immigration

Girl, Serpent, Thorn

Melissa Bashardoust

Fantasy, Romance

Girl, Unframed

Deb Caletti

Realistic Fiction, Coming of Age

Gutless

Carl Deuker

Realistic Fiction, Sports

Running Full Tilt

Michael Currinder

Realistic Fiction, Sports

Steelheart

Brandon Sanderson

Fantasy, Science Fiction

The Language of Thorns

Leigh Bardugo

Fantasy, Short Stories

The Night Circus

Erin Morgenstern

Fantasy, Romance

The Rest of the Story

Sarah Dessen

Realistic Fiction, Romance

Golden Arm

Carl Deuker

Realistic Fiction, Sports

Losers Take All

David Klass

Realistic Fiction, Sports

Shatter Me

Tahereh Mafi

Science Fiction, Dystopia

The Collectors: Stories

A. S. King

Short Stories, Magical Realism

The Magic Fish

Trung Le Nguyen

Graphic Novel, LGBTQ+

The Only Good Indians

Stephen Graham Jones

Horror, Literary Fiction

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NONFICTION

Everything Is Tuberculosis

John Green

Narrative Nonfiction, Public Health

Almost American Girl

Robin Ha

Graphic Memoir, Immigration

Bomb

Steve Sheinkin

History, WWII, Science

The Color of Water

James McBride

Memoir, Race, Family

Games of Deception

Andrew Maraniss

History, Sports, Nazi Germany

Gone to the Woods

Gary Paulsen

Memoir, Survival

Hothouse Earth

Stephanie Sammartino McPherson

Nonfiction, Climate

Laughing at My Nightmare

Shane Burcaw

Memoir, Disability

Proud (Young Readers Edition)

Ibtihaj Muhammad

Memoir, Sports

Samurai Rising

Pamela S. Turner

Biography, History

The Grand Escape

Neal Bascomb

Narrative Nonfiction, History

The Weather Machine

Andrew Blum

Nonfiction, Science

When Nobody Was Watching

Carli Lloyd

Memoir, Sports

Accused!

Larry Dane Brimmer

History, Civil Rights

Americanized: Rebel Without a Green Card

Sara Saedi

Memoir, Immigration, Identity

Breakfast with Einstein

Chad Orzel

Science, Quantum Physics

The Freedom Summer Murders

Don Mitchell

History, Civil Rights

The Glass Castle

Jeannette Walls

Memoir, Family, Coming of Age

Hometown Victory

Keanon Lowe

Memoir, Sports

Imperfect

Tim Brown

Memoir, Sports

Life in Motion

Misty Copeland

Memoir, Ballet

Run and Hide

Don Brown

Graphic Nonfiction, History

Shout

Laurie Halse Anderson

Memoir in Verse, Trauma

The Keeper

Tim Howard

Memoir, Sports

Undefeated

Steve Sheinkin

Narrative Nonfiction, Sports